

2010

SOUTH AFRICA



Crash and burn: Internal conflicts saw France collapse completely at the first World Cup held in Africa. A public fallout between players and head coach Raymond Domenech culminated in a humiliating group-stage exit, with host South Africa delivering the final blow (in pic). AP



Hand of infamy: Uruguay's Luis Suarez (left) became public enemy No. 1 in Africa — especially in Ghana — after his handball in the 120th minute denied the African side a semifinal berth. Asamoah Gyan's subsequent penalty miss, followed by Ghana's shootout defeat, only deepened the heartbreak. AP



Tactical triumph: Spain's tiki-taka took over the footballing world. The nation's golden generation added the World Cup title to its glittering era by defeating the Netherlands, with Andres Iniesta (in pic) scoring deep into extra time. REUTERS